



The Gender Gap in Household Tasks and Child Care Over Time

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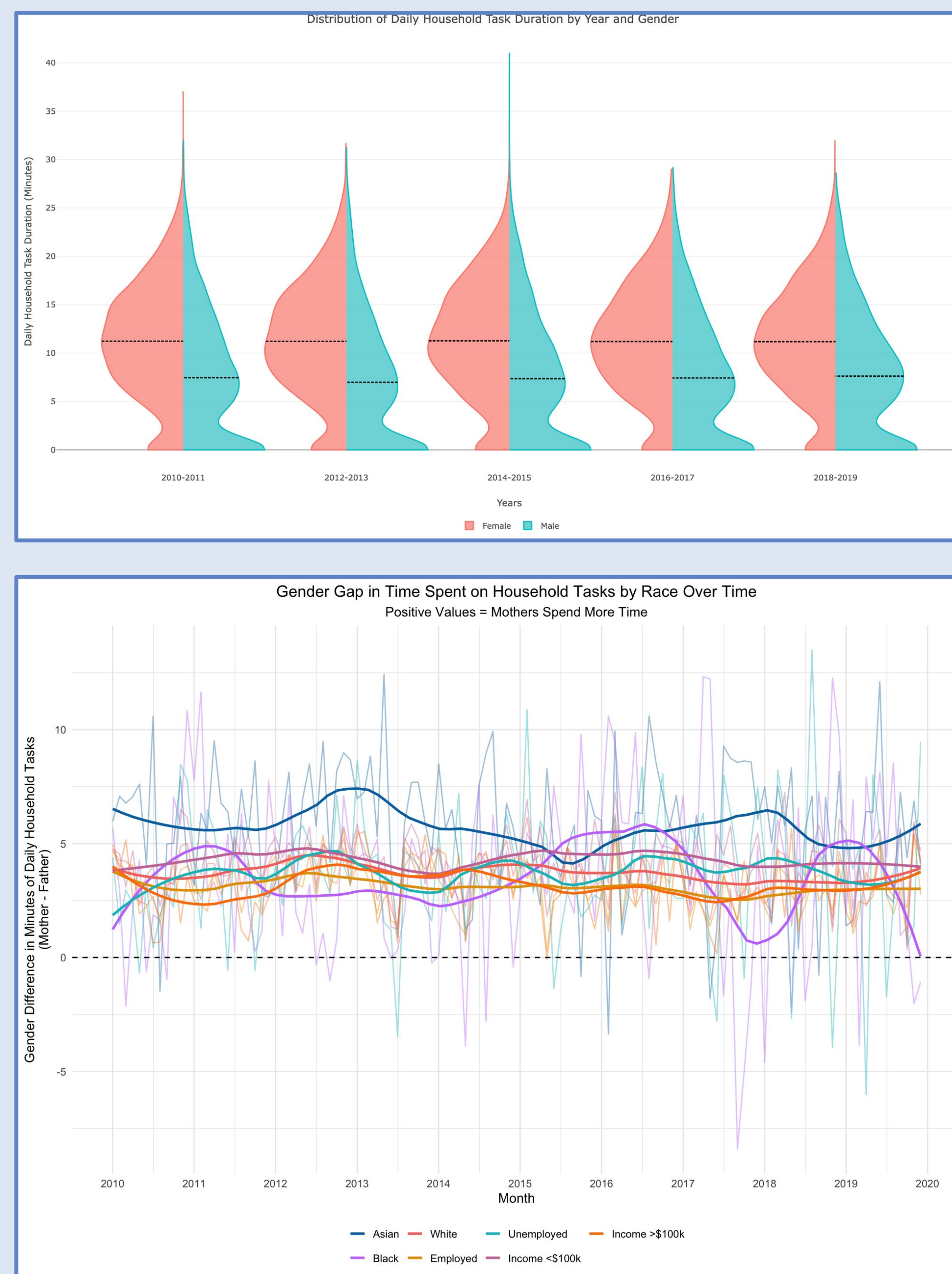
Introduction

- **Research Question**
 - Within heterosexual two-parent households with at least one child under age 18, how has the gender gap in time spent on unpaid household labor and primary childcare changed between 2010 and 2019?
- **Background**
 - The gender gap in time allocation for both paid and unpaid work decreased from 2000 to 2010 across 24 countries, though the gender gaps in unpaid work and childcare time still persist. ([Iza World of Labor](#))
- **Motivation**
 - Women continue to bear a disproportionate share of unpaid household work and child care despite workplace gender equality progress.
 - Understanding changes in these gaps over time can inform policy decisions.
 - Medium-run time use trends in the 2010s remain understudied.

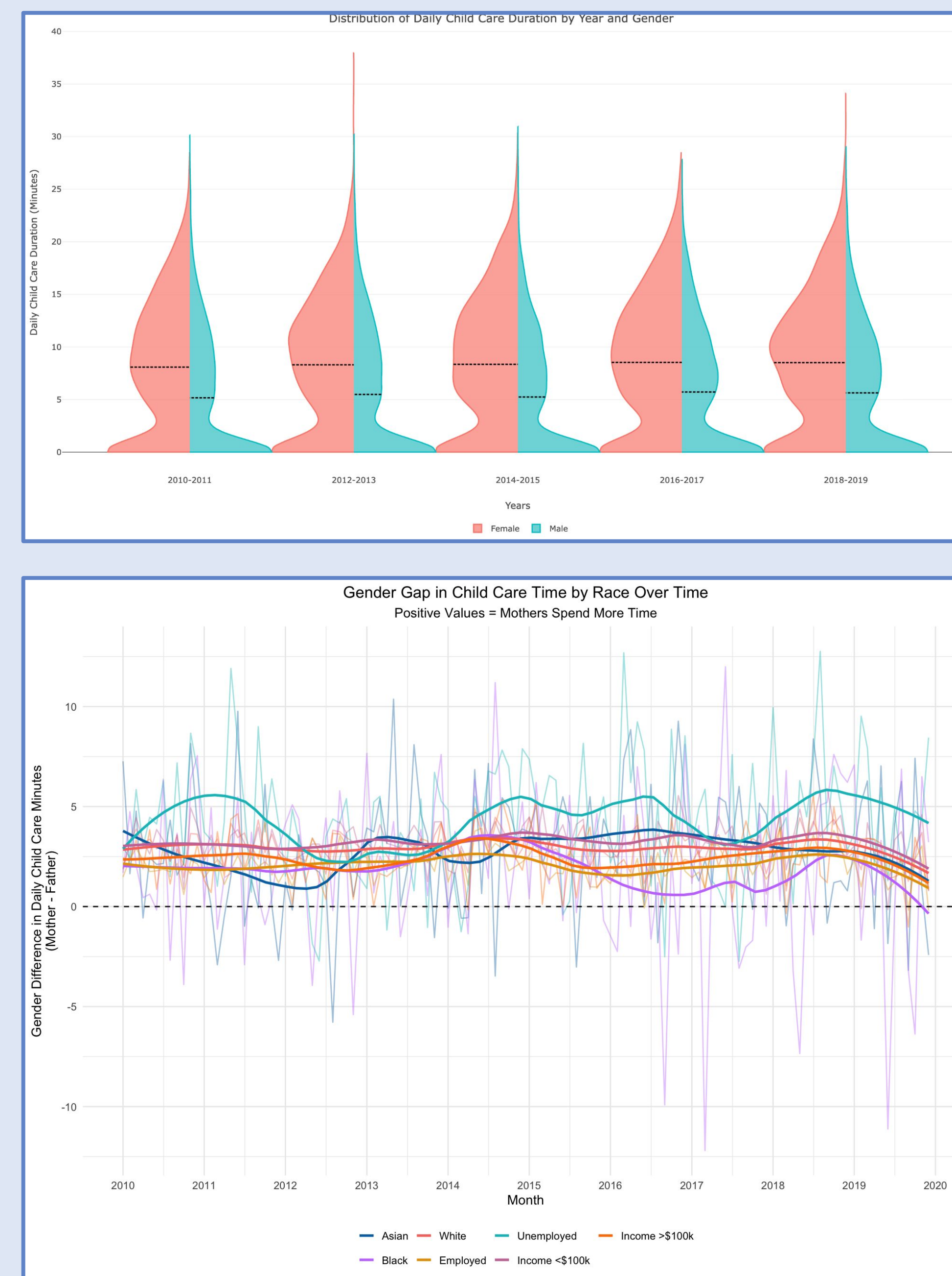
Data & Methods

- **Data Sources**
 - ATUS respondent, activity, roster, and CPS datasets from 2010-2019
- **Data Manipulation**
 - First, I filtered the ATUS datasets to only include parents within 2-parent heterosexual households with at least one child under age 18
 - Second, I merged the 40 datasets together for analysis
- **Sequence of Analyses**
 - Visualizations
 - Violin plots for mothers vs. fathers
 - Gender gap time series plots
 - Multiple linear regressions
 - 2 outcome variables: sqrt child care duration, sqrt household tasks duration
 - 2 two time variables (continuous vs. categorical)

Results: Household Tasks



Results: Child Care



Conclusion

- **Overall**
 - Figures show that the gender gaps in time spent on household tasks and child care remained relatively steady throughout the 2010s.
 - F-statistics show that gender, time, and their interaction meaningfully explain variation in child care duration and household tasks duration.
- **Household Tasks**
 - On average, women spend 3.86 more minutes daily on child care than men. ■ That is 23.48 more hours per year.
 - The largest gender gap over time occurs for Asian respondents.
- **Child Care**
 - On average, women spend 2.90 more minutes daily on child care than men. ■ That is 17.64 more hours per year.
 - The largest gender gap over time occurs for unemployed respondents.
 - There is a slight narrowing of the gender gap beginning in mid-2018.

Data Ethics & Limitations

- **Data Ethics**
 - Ethical data: anonymized dataset from the publically available ATUS study administered by the US Bureau of Labor Statistics.
 - Race: race-based findings should be interpreted within the context of broader structural and historical inequities.
- **Limitations**
 - Household structures: this study focuses on two-parent heterosexual households (which excludes many family structures), so findings should not be generalized beyond these family compositions.
 - Reporting bias: respondents may over- or under-report time spent on certain activities that may differ systematically by gender.

Results: Household Tasks & Child Care

Relationship Between Gender + Time and Sqrt Child Care Duration + Sqrt Household Tasks Duration				
	(1) Sqrt Child Care Duration	(2) Sqrt Household Tasks Duration	(3) Sqrt Child Care Duration	(4) Sqrt Household Tasks Duration
Male	-18.591 (13.595)	-0.988*** (0.302)	-20.661* (12.116)	-1.089*** (0.270)
Year	0.007 (0.005)		0.003 (0.004)	
Date		0.00002 (0.00001)		0.00001 (0.00001)
Male * Year	0.009 (0.007)		0.010* (0.006)	
Male * Date		0.00003 (0.00002)		0.00002 (0.00002)
Weekend	-0.322*** (0.019)		0.388*** (0.017)	
Employed	-0.445*** (0.026)	-0.449*** (0.026)	-0.500*** (0.023)	-0.511*** (0.023)
Income Level	0.099*** (0.009)	0.100*** (0.009)	0.028*** (0.008)	0.029*** (0.008)
Asian	0.087** (0.038)	0.090** (0.038)	-0.066** (0.034)	-0.071** (0.034)
Black	-0.260*** (0.042)	-0.263*** (0.043)	-0.242*** (0.038)	-0.247*** (0.038)
Multiracial	-0.021 (0.091)	-0.038 (0.092)	-0.064 (0.081)	-0.044 (0.082)
Sqrt Household Tasks Duration	0.123*** (0.007)	0.107*** (0.007)		
Sqrt Child Care Duration			0.098*** (0.006)	0.086*** (0.006)
Constant	-12.051 (9.484)	1.767*** (0.228)	-3.690 (8.453)	2.871*** (0.203)
F-Statistic (Gender, Time, Gender * Time)	220.600	229.048	499.278	497.283
F-Test P-Value	< 0.001***	< 0.001***	< 0.001***	< 0.001***
Observations	23,912	23,912	23,912	23,912
Adjusted R-Squared	0.099	0.089	0.150	0.132
State Dummy	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes

Notes: The outcome variable in models (1) and (2) is the square root of the time spent on child care per day. The outcome variable in models (3) and (4) is the square root of the time spent completing household tasks per day. Models (1) and (3) include a categorical year variable, while models (2) and (4) include a continuous date variable. The F-Statistic and F-Test P-Value rows report results from an ANOVA comparison between each full model and a restricted model excluding gender, time, and their interaction; a significant p-value indicates that the terms jointly improve model fit. *** p < 0.01, ** p < 0.05, * p < 0.1

